

Independent Sanctions Screening Module Testing

Below are the initial observations based on independent testing and are intended to highlight priority areas for enhancement before deeper or expanded validation. Overall, baseline sanctions detection is functioning. However, several gaps in alias handling, name normalization and hit-level transparency introduce false-negative and auditability risks that should be addressed.

As an immediate recommendation, it would be helpful to enhance the tool to provide visibility into hit-level details and the specific alias names that trigger alerts. Without this information, it is difficult to independently validate why an alert was generated, which limits the effectiveness of the current review. This capability is a core requirement for sanctions Watchmans, as it materially improves explainability, supports effective alert disposition and reduces operational and audit risk.

	Observations	Test Feedback
1	Difference in match counts detected between Watchman and OFAC list. Samples: “ABU BAKR AL-BAGHDADI” generated 1 potential match in Watchman and 4 in the OFAC list. “AL SHABAAB” generated 4 potential matches in Watchman and 11 in the OFAC list. The SDN hit was successfully identified and alerted with a high score. The differences in match counts likely reflect internal alias handling and do not impact baseline sanctions detection under exact-name conditions based on scenarios tested. However, the application currently does not provide sufficient match-level detail or alias visibility to confirm which specific records or aliases triggered the alert independently. This limits transparency and makes it difficult to fully validate match accuracy.	When screening “ABU BAKR AL-BAGHDADI,” the solution correctly resolved the input to the sanctioned individual’s primary name (“AL-BADRI, Dr. Ibrahim ‘Awwad Ibrahim ‘Ali”). The Score Trace report explicitly identified the matched alias (“AL-BAGHDADI, Abu Bakr al-Husayni”), confirming appropriate alias linkage at the detailed review level. Same with “AL SHABAAB” as well. Issue: The initial screening results display only the primary sanctioned name (e.g., “AL-BADRI, Dr. Ibrahim ‘Awwad Ibrahim ‘Ali”). In practice, analysts rely heavily on the names displayed in the search results to determine which hits to open and review. The absence of the searched alias in the result view may cause the alert to be overlooked or deprioritized during initial triage, despite correct underlying detection. This creates an operational false-negative risk, driven by analyst workflow rather than matching logic. Recommendation: Show the matched alias names as the search results level. Refer to the images below which show how OFAC lists the hits. OFAC lists the alias names matching the searched name.

		Lookup Results: 4 Found Name ABU BAKR AL-BAGHDADI AL-BAGHDADI, Abu Bakr al-Husayni AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husayni AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husseini Aliases: <table><thead><tr><th>Type</th><th>Category</th><th>Name</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>weak</td><td>ABU DU'A</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>weak</td><td>DR. IBRAHIM</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-SAMARRA'I, Ibrahim 'Awad Ibrahim al-Badri</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-SAMARRA'I, Ibrahim Awwad Ibrahim</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-SAMARRA'I, Dr. Ibrahim Awwad Ibrahim</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>weak</td><td>ABU BAKR AL-BAGHDADI</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husseini</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husayni</td></tr><tr><td>a.k.a.</td><td>strong</td><td>AL-BAGHDADI, Abu Bakr al-Husayni</td></tr></tbody></table>	Type	Category	Name	a.k.a.	weak	ABU DU'A	a.k.a.	weak	DR. IBRAHIM	a.k.a.	strong	AL-SAMARRA'I, Ibrahim 'Awad Ibrahim al-Badri	a.k.a.	strong	AL-SAMARRA'I, Ibrahim Awwad Ibrahim	a.k.a.	strong	AL-SAMARRA'I, Dr. Ibrahim Awwad Ibrahim	a.k.a.	weak	ABU BAKR AL-BAGHDADI	a.k.a.	strong	AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husseini	a.k.a.	strong	AL-QURASHI, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi al-Husayni	a.k.a.	strong	AL-BAGHDADI, Abu Bakr al-Husayni
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2	Screening results indicate sensitivity to name order for records. Sample: “AL-JASIM, Muhammad Husayn” Vs. “Muhammad Husayn AL-JASIM” This behavior indicates a potential false-negative risk where sanctioned individuals may not be detected if name components are presented in a different order.	Recent updates have resolved name-order sensitivity for full names. Issue: Further testing indicates limitations in handling partial name inputs. Screening using a shortened name format (e.g., “Muhammad AL-JASIM”) did not generate any hits in the Watchman, whereas the OFAC reference list returned multiple matching records. Given that real-world customer and transaction data frequently omits middle names, this behavior may present a potential false-negative risk. Recommendation: Enhance name normalization and matching logic to ensure that the matches are detected when screened using partial name formats and combinations (e.g., first and last name, mid and last name, etc.).																														

		Lookup Type: All Name: Muhammad AL-JASIM ID # / Digital Currency Address: Program: All 561-Related BALKANS BALKANS-EO14033 Minimum Name Score: 100 Lookup Results: 6 Found <table><thead><tr><th>Name</th><th>Address</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>AL-AJUZ, Sami Jasim Muhammad</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>AL-JABURI, Sami Jasim Muhammad</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>AL-JASIM, Muhammad Husayn</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>AL-KHALIDI, Faysal Jasim Muhammad al-Amiri</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>AL-KHALIDI, Faysal Jasim Muhammad al-Umari</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>MUHAMMAD, Sami Jasim</td><td></td></tr></tbody></table> Test Search Test current configuration with real queries Search Name Muhammad AL-JASIM Entity Type (optional) Person ☒ Enable ScoreTrace Run Search Results: 0 matches No matches found	Name	Address	AL-AJUZ, Sami Jasim Muhammad		AL-JABURI, Sami Jasim Muhammad		AL-JASIM, Muhammad Husayn		AL-KHALIDI, Faysal Jasim Muhammad al-Amiri		AL-KHALIDI, Faysal Jasim Muhammad al-Umari		MUHAMMAD, Sami Jasim	
Name	Address															
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3	The application does not provide sufficient identifying attributes (such as date of birth, place of birth, nationality, location or identification numbers) to support effective alert disposition. The absence of this information limits the ability to mitigate or clear potential false positives. Providing visibility into matched aliases and underlying list records would strengthen explainability, support auditability and improve confidence in screening outcomes.	The identifying attributes are not available. This limitation remains after recent enhancements. It is also recommended to display other information available from the source list (e.g., List, Program, Remarks, Address, Type (Ind or entity), etc.), in addition to core identifying attributes, to support effective alert disposition and auditability.														
4	Screening using certain alias-only inputs (e.g., “AL-MALIZI,” an OFAC-listed alias of Abu Sayyaf) did not generate the same match in Watchman. This indicates a potential false-negative risk, where sanctioned individuals/entities may not be detected correctly when screened using alternate or less common names.	The issue persists.														

	Lookup Type: All Name: AL-MALIZI ID # / Digital Currency Address: Program: All 561-Related BALKANS BALKANS-EO14033 Minimum Name Score: 100 Lookup Results: 1 Found <table><thead><tr><th>Name</th><th>Address</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>AL-MALIZI, Abu Sayyaf</td><td></td></tr></tbody></table> Search Name AL-MALIZI Entity Type (optional) All Types ☒ Enable ScoreTrace Run Search Results: 1 matches View ScoreTrace Report AL-MALIKI, Shabib Lazem - Match: 88.0% Type: PERSON Source: US_OFAC	Name	Address	AL-MALIZI, Abu Sayyaf		
Name	Address					
AL-MALIZI, Abu Sayyaf						
5	When screening using an alias name, the application returns a hit against the primary sanctioned entity/individual, but does not display the specific alias that triggered the match. As a result, it is not possible to confirm whether the alert was generated due to an exact alias match or broader name similarity, limiting the ability to independently validate match accuracy. Search Name Muhammad IBN AL-HUSAYN Entity Type (optional) All Types ☒ Enable ScoreTrace Run Search Results: 1 matches View ScoreTrace Report AG ALHOUSSEINI, Houka Houka - Match: 100.0% Type: PERSON Source: US_OFAC Search Name Muhammad Yunis Ahmad AL-BADRANI Entity Type (optional) All Types ☒ Enable ScoreTrace Run Search Results: 1 matches View ScoreTrace Report AHMAD, Muhammad Yunis - Match: 100.0% Type: PERSON Source: US_OFAC It is recommended that the matched alias name be clearly displayed alongside the primary sanctioned name at the search result, rather than only within detailed reports. This would support effective analyst triage, improve explainability and enable independent validation of alias-based matches.					
6	It is recommended that the sanctions screening workflow follow a clear and intuitive analyst flow: Search -> Search Results -> Detailed Hit View.					

	The search results page should display sufficient contextual information (including the matched alias name) to allow analysts to identify relevant hits for review before navigating to the detailed view. This approach aligns with standard sanctions screening workflows and supports effective triage, explainability and auditability. 1. Search page a. Analyst enters the name (customer/counterparty) b. Other details to narrow down the results (like Date of Birth, Country) c. Possibly applies filters (list type - only OFAC currently, entity type) 2. Search results a. Shows all potential hits b. Must display enough context to decide which results to open: (Primary Name, Matched alias names, List (OFAC SDN), Score. 3. Detailed hit view a. Full identifying attributes b. Alias list c. Remarks/sanctions program d. Match explanation (Score Trace) e. Print option with date and time stamp	
7	Testing indicates that the Watchman is sensitive to the presence of additional or noise word components (such as titles, honorifics – Mr. / Mrs. / Ms. / Dr. / Prof / Sir / H.E. / Bin / Ibn / Sheikh / Jr / Sr, etc.). When extra signs are included alongside the core name, match results may be degraded or suppressed, despite the sanctioned name being present. Eg: Mr. Muhammad Husayn AL-JASIM Vs Muhammad Husayn AL-JASIM	

	Given that real-world customer and transaction data frequently contains such noise, this behavior presents a potential false-negative risk where sanctioned individuals or entities may not be detected.	
8	Testing using common personal names (Eg: Muhammad Ali, Abdul Rahman) resulted in limited match results being returned by the Watchman, whereas the OFAC reference list produced multiple matching records for the same input. It may indicate early-stage filtering or sensitivity constraints that prevent relevant OFAC records from being surfaced for analyst review. While this is being fixed, it is recommended to have other details in the search page to narrow down the results (like Date of Birth, nationality / Country).	
9	Entity Vs Individual Record Coverage - Testing using the name "Abu Sayyaf" resulted in the Watchman returning the entity-level designation only, whereas the OFAC reference list returned both entity and associated individual records. The absence of individual-level hits in the screening results may limit analyst visibility into all relevant sanctioned parties associated with the searched name. It is recommended that Watchman surface both entity and individual records where applicable when a searched name or alias is associated with multiple OFAC record types.	

Search Name

Abu Sayyaf

Entity Type (optional)

All Types

☒ Enable ScoreTrace

Run Search

Results: 2 matches

[View ScoreTrace Report](#)

ABU SAYYAF GROUP - Match: 95.0%

Type: BUSINESS | Source: US_OFAC

ABU SAYYAF GROUP - Match: 95.0%

Type: BUSINESS | Source: US_OFAC

Lookup

Type:

All

Name:

Abu Sayyaf

ID # / Digital Currency Address:

Program:

All

561-Related

BALKANS

BALKANS-EO14033

Minimum Name Score:

100

Lookup Results: 2 Found

Name

Address

[ABU SAYYAF GROUP](#)

[AL-MALIZI, Abu Sayyaf](#)